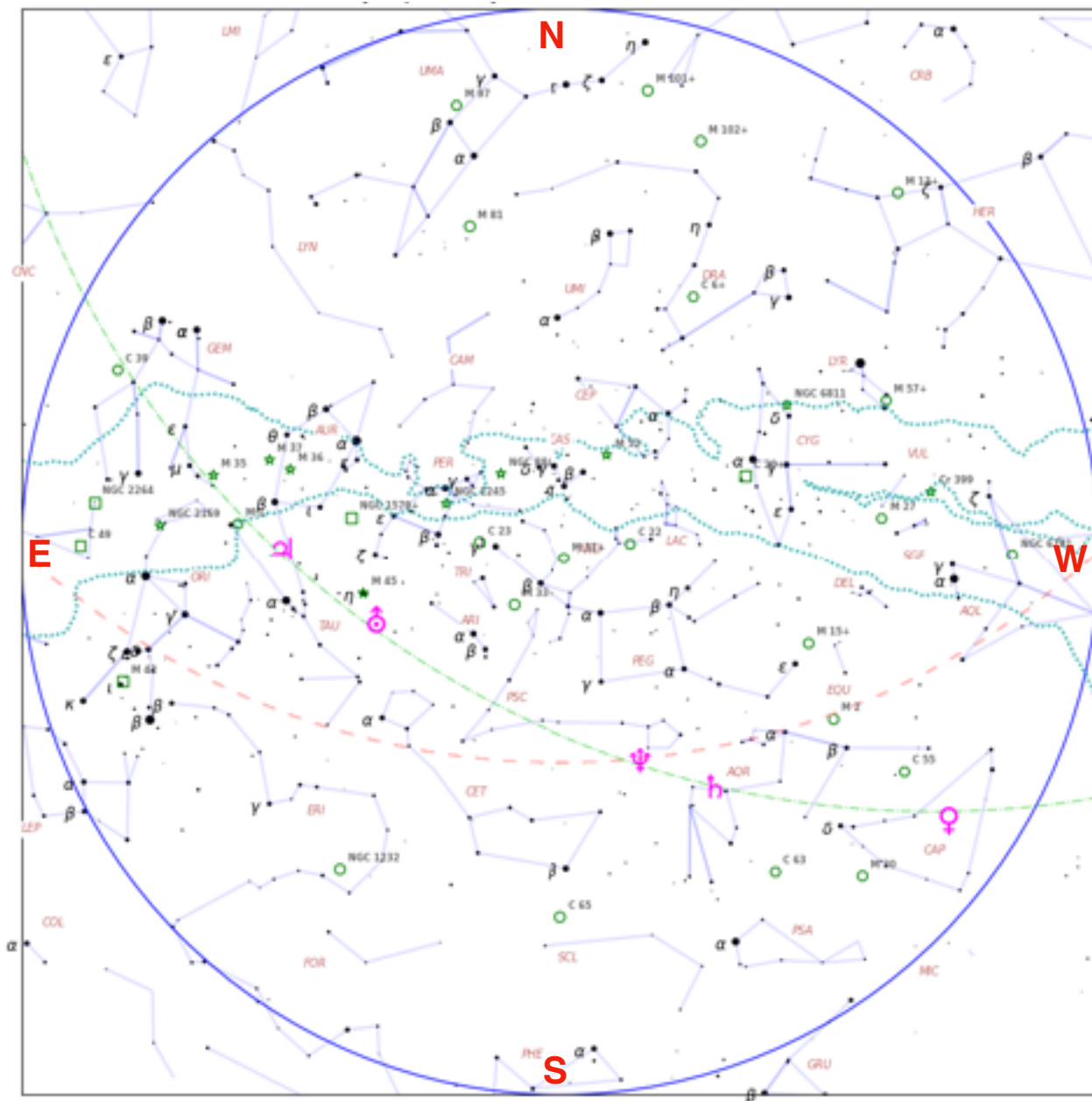


DECEMBER 2024



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Winter Solstice

The longest nights of the year happen at the end of the month. Now the Milky stretches from the East to the West, with Cassiopeia overhead, stretching down through Perseus and Auriga to Orion rising in the East.

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 AQL - Aquila - *the Eagle*
 AQR - Aquarius - *the Water Bearer*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAP - Capricornus - *the Goat*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DEL - Delphinus - *the Dolphin*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 EQU - Equuleus - *the Little Horse*
 ERI - Eridanus - *the River*
 FOR - Fornax - *the Furnace*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 GRU - Grus - *the Crane*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Lesser Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - *the Harp*
 MIC - Microscopium - *the Microscope*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PHE - Phoenix - *the Phoenix*
 PSA - Piscis Austrinus - *the Southern Fish*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 SGE - Sagitta - *the Arrow*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VUL - Vulpecula - *the Little Fox*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Dec 1	8:00 PM (EDT)
Dec 8	7:30 PM
Dec 15	7:00 PM
Dec 22	6:30 PM
Dec 29	6:00 PM

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Venus is in Capricornus, easily visible after sunset.

Saturn is easy to find in the SW sky below the Great Square of Pegasus and above the bright star Fomalhaut hugging the southern horizon.

Jupiter is climbing in the E between the horns of Taurus.

Mars rises about 1hr later from the time of the map, close to the open cluster Praesepe in Cancer.

Uranus and **Neptune** are findable in binoculars (and a finder chart) in Taurus (near the Pleiades) and Pisces, respectively.